

EVIDENCE ROOM

Brand System

Operating Evidence

Internal · Brand

Operating Evidence · Not legal, tax, or accounting advice

Evidence Room — Brand System

Document ID: 11_BRAND/01_BRAND_SYSTEM **Version:** 1.0 **Aesthetic north star:** Institutional investment research × Bloomberg terminal clarity × Stripe product discipline × Linear interface restraint × Palantir operational gravity × McKinsey structural prose. **Hard exclusions:** Purple AI kitsch, neon brains, robot mascots, glassmorphism glow stacks, Inter/Roboto/Arial as brand faces, “revolutionary / magical / autonomous finance” copy.

1. Brand idea alternatives (evaluated)

A	Control Tower	See every AP agent from one vantage	Intuitive ops metaphor	Overused in SaaS; implies software monitoring product	6.5
B	Chartered Agents	Every agent holds a written charter before it acts	Strong governance signal	Narrow; sounds legalistic; underplays measurement & exceptions	7.0
C	Responsibility Ledger	Autonomy is earned and recorded	Differentiated; audit-native	“Ledger” collides with accounting noun; easy to confuse with GL	7.5
D	Payables OS	Operating system for AP agents	Clear category claim	Generic “OS” SaaS cliché; weak on evidence/audit emotion	6.0
E	Operating Evidence	Evidence is the operating principle — design, prove, then expand	Owns the product name; unifies controls + KPIs + method; institutional tone	Requires discipline to avoid sounding like a document archive	9.0

Winner: **E — Operating Evidence**

Rationale

- 1 Extends the existing product name (**Evidence Room**) into a usable idea: the room where operating evidence for AP agents is designed and kept.
- 2 Aligns with buyer fear (audit, control, payment risk) better than “AI platform” language.
- 3 Differentiates cleanly from stack vendors (features), RPA (bots), prompt packs (novelty), and consultancies (projects).
- 4 Scales across tiers without changing personality — Free diagnostic through Blueprint.
- 5 Visually supports an institutional research aesthetic rather than consumer AI chrome.

Brand idea (locked): > Evidence Room is where Finance builds **operating evidence** for AP agents — charters, controls, exception logic, KPIs, and earned responsibility — before autonomy expands.

2. Positioning statement

For Controllers, Heads of AP, Shared Services leaders, and Finance Directors in complex, ERP-backed organisations **Who** must adopt AI in Accounts Payable without surrendering control **Evidence Room** is the **AP Agent Operating System toolkit** **That** provides implementation-ready agent design, governance, exception taxonomy, KPI measurement, and a responsibility-earning methodology **Unlike** AP automation vendors, RPA platforms, prompt marketplaces, or consulting slide packs **Evidence Room** sells the portable operating layer that sits across any ERP or AP stack — not another system of record, and never autonomous payment software.

3. Messaging pillars

1. Operating system, not prompts	Agents need jobs, owners, exclusions, and escalations.	16-agent library; charters; RACI
2. Responsibility is earned	L0→L4. Full autonomy is never default.	Responsibility model; pilot gates
3. Exception taxonomy as OS	Exceptions are a system, not a backlog aesthetic.	Taxonomy, triage, root-cause agents
4. Evidence before expansion	If you cannot show who owned it and what changed, it does not scale.	KPI packs; audit evidence standards
5. ERP-agnostic by design	Useful across Dynamics, SAP, Oracle, NetSuite, Workday and peers.	Stack-neutral templates; no rip-and-replace

4. Voice rules

Be

- Intelligent, concise, specific
- Executive: short sentences, concrete nouns
- Credible: attribute market claims; refuse invented stats
- Calm under pressure: control language, not hype

Do

- Prefer verbs of design and governance: define, charter, baseline, shadow, escalate, measure
- Name artefacts: “Exception Triage Agent charter,” “L2 Prepare gate”
- Use plain finance English

Do not

- Promise guaranteed savings, fraud detection, compliance, accounting accuracy, or ROI
- Anthropomorphise agents as colleagues who “care”
- Use exclamation marks in product UI or covers
- Write like a growth newsletter

Banned language

Revolutionary / game-changing / magical	Hype	Specific capability
Autonomous AP / autonomous payments	Violates product identity	Human-authorised payments; earned responsibility
Guaranteed ROI / X% savings (unsourced)	Invented or misattributed outcomes	Sourced market context + measurement design
AI-powered (as decoration)	Empty	Name the agent and control
Seamless / frictionless	Untrue for controls work	Explicit gates; deliberate friction
Ninja / rockstar / hack	Unprofessional	Role titles
Disrupt / uber for X	Cliché	Operating layer / toolkit
Purple-brain / robot imagery copy	Aesthetic ban	Institutional descriptors

5. Logo direction

Mark concept: A squared “room” frame — thin institutional rule — with a single vertical **evidence bar** (like a column in a table or a tick in a control register). Not a brain, shield-with-circuit, or chatbot bubble.

Variants

- **Primary:** Symbol + wordmark locked left
- **Compact:** Symbol alone for favicon / app tile
- **Inverse:** Symbol + wordmark on Ink (`#0B1220`)
- **Monochrome:** Single-ink for print / fax / audit packs

Clear space: Minimum padding = height of the capital **E** in the wordmark. **Minimum size:** Symbol 16px digital; wordmark not below 96px width.

Do not: Add gradients inside the mark, animate “neural” pulses, or place the mark on photography of robots.

6. Wordmark

Lockup: EVIDENCE ROOM in two words, tracking slightly open, all caps for covers; title case (Evidence Room) in body prose.

Subtitle system (covers only, never louder than brand): AP Agent OS · tier name in smaller weight (e.g. Professional).

Incorrect: EvidenceRoom (closed compound in display), evidence room (lowercase brand), ER alone as customer-facing brand.

7. Typography

Institutional pairing — **editorial serif for display, precise grotesque for UI/body**. Never Inter, Roboto, Arial, Helvetica Neue as brand defaults, or Comic/Display novelty faces.



Display / covers	Tiempos Headline	`Tiempos Headline`, `Newsreader`, `Source Serif 4`, Georgia, serif	High-contrast editorial; used for H1 and cover titles
Body / longform	Tiempos Text	`Tiempos Text`, `Newsreader`, `Source Serif 4`, Georgia, serif	Research-memo readability
UI / tables / labels	IBM Plex Sans	`IBM Plex Sans`, `Source Sans 3`, `Segoe UI`, sans-serif	Tabular figures on; institutional not startup
Data / mono	IBM Plex Mono	`IBM Plex Mono`, `ui-monospace`, monospace	KPIs, IDs, ledger codes

Scale (desktop)

`--type-display`	40/48	Tiempos Headline 600
`--type-h1`	32/40	Tiempos Headline 600
`--type-h2`	24/32	Tiempos Headline 600
`--type-h3`	18/28	IBM Plex Sans 600
`--type-body`	16/26	Tiempos Text 400
`--type-small`	13/20	IBM Plex Sans 400
`--type-label`	11/16	IBM Plex Sans 600 · tracking 0.06em · uppercase

8. Colour system

Institutional ink on paper. Single signal accent. No purple. No neon.

Ink	`#0B1220`	Primary text, wordmark, rules
Ink muted	`#3A4458`	Secondary text
Rule	`#C9CED8`	Hairlines, table rules
Paper	`#F4F6F8`	Page background (cool paper — not cream cliché)
Paper elevated	`#FFFFFF`	Cards only when interaction requires containment
Panel	`#E8EDF2`	Section bands, cover fields
Signal	`#9C2B1F`	Alerts, exceptions, destructive — sparingly
Measure	`#1F4E79`	Links, selected states, chart primary series
Positive	`#2F5D50`	Favourable variance (never “AI green glow”)
Caution	`#8A6A1F`	Warnings, L3 gate notices

Chart grid	`#DDE2EA`	Plot grids
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Atmosphere (allowed): subtle horizontal rule fields, faint blueprint grid at 3–4% opacity, paper grain at very low opacity. **Forbidden:** purple→indigo gradients, meshed blob backgrounds, dark-mode-as-default marketing pages.

9. Iconography

- 1.25px stroke, square caps, no filled neon pictograms
- Geometric, 24px grid
- Prefer: charter document, gate, branch (exception), gauge, room frame
- Avoid: robots, sparkles, brain chips, rockets

10. Chart, table, callout, cover system

Charts

- Single primary series in **Measure** (`#1F4E79`); comparison series in Ink muted
- No 3D, no gradients in bars, no glow
- Always source footnotes beneath charts that use Research Ledger data
- Zero baseline for bar charts; label units

Tables

- Hairline rules in **Rule**; header row in **Panel**
- IBM Plex Sans 13/20; numeric columns right-aligned with tabular lining figures
- No zebra stripes unless table exceeds ~12 rows — then 3% Ink wash

Callouts

Four types only:

Note	Measure	Clarifying operating guidance
Control	Ink	Mandatory control / exclusion
Exception	Signal	Exception or risk callout
Non-evidence	Caution	Scenario numbers; must say NON-EVIDENCE

Covers

- Full-bleed **Ink** or **Paper** field — not stock photo collage
- Brand wordmark top-left
- One title (display serif)
- One deck line
- Tier + document ID bottom rule
- No badges, stickers, or “AI powered” chips on the hero plane

11. Motion (when UI exists)

Intentional, few:

- 1 Cover rule draws left→right 200ms

2 Table row focus state fades 120ms

3 Page section crossfade 180ms

No bouncing CTAs, no particle fields.

12. Application checklist

- ☐ Brand idea “Operating Evidence” intact on first viewport
 - ☐ No banned language
 - ☐ Market stats attributed + ledger ID where relevant
 - ☐ Typography from approved stacks only
 - ☐ Colour tokens only from this system / `02\_VISUAL\_TOKENS.css`
 - ☐ Cover passes brand test: remove nav — still unmistakably Evidence Room
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End of Brand System v1.0. Visual tokens implement this file in 02_VISUAL_TOKENS.css.